Competitive landscape

The closest comparators, the Canadian field, and the eight parts of the job measured against sixteen named rivals.

Competitive diligence
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4orm Finance · Confidential

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How to read the evidence classes.

Verified is a figure confirmed against a primary source on the date shown. **Company claim** is a figure a company publishes about itself, with no independent measurement basis. **Customer case** is a result a vendor publishes about one named deployment, not an average and not a controlled study. **4orm target** is something we intend to prove and have not proved. Overlap is a structured feature comparison. It is not a market-share estimate.

01 · THE REGISTER

The primitives are crowded. The assembly is thin, and it is not empty.

428 core marks across 105 companies

Evidence, consent, case handling, reconciliation, drafting and connectivity each have funded vendors behind them. What the register found least often is the consumer-controlled front end and Canadian rule content held inside the product.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- No page in this book claims a category nobody has entered.
- Companies own pieces. In the United Kingdom, Aveni now joins several of those pieces at case level.
- Threat is two things: structured feature overlap, and the scale, capital and distribution that let a vendor reach the buyer.

Source: public information only. Register cut August 2026. Named capabilities re-checked September 2026.

THE REGISTER

What the register covers

One hundred and five companies scored on the same twelve capability categories, then sixteen of them measured against the eight parts of the job.

105	12	54	16
COMPANIES AND PRODUCTS READ	CAPABILITY CATEGORIES	PROCESS AND FEATURE CHECKS	RIVALS MEASURED AGAINST THE JOB

The register is wider than a competitor list. It holds direct products, vertical systems of record, infrastructure, governance tooling and adjacent platforms, because the strategic question is who can reach the buyer, not who is selling against us this quarter.

On Canadian specialisation.

No company in the 105-company register scored Canadian regulatory rule content as a **core** capability, meaning the thing a buyer is paying for. That is a scoring result about core capability. It is not a finding that Canadian regulatory features are absent from the field: Part 2 names Canadian vendors that carry compliance packages, suitability forms and anti-money-laundering workflows today.

Register cut August 2026, public product pages only. Canadian vendor capabilities re-checked September 2026. Scope: published product pages. Status: our own reading.

THE REGISTER

The twelve categories, and what each one asks

01 **Consumer understanding**
What the consumer was told and understood.

02 **Suitability rationale**
Why this product suited this consumer.

03 **Transaction and case record**
The authoritative record of the file.

04 **Evidence and provenance**
Where each fact came from.

05 **Consent and privacy**
What the consumer agreed to, and when.

06 **Cross-system ingestion**
Pulling records in from other systems.

07 **Rules and compliance controls**
The rules the file is tested against.

08 **Human approval**
Who signed, and on what.

09 **Change and version history**
What changed, when, and by whose hand.

10 **Complaint evidence**
What happened when the consumer complained.

11 **Regulator and audit outputs**
The pack an examiner is handed.

12 **Cross-vertical portability**
The same system across more than one industry.

Reading a mark.

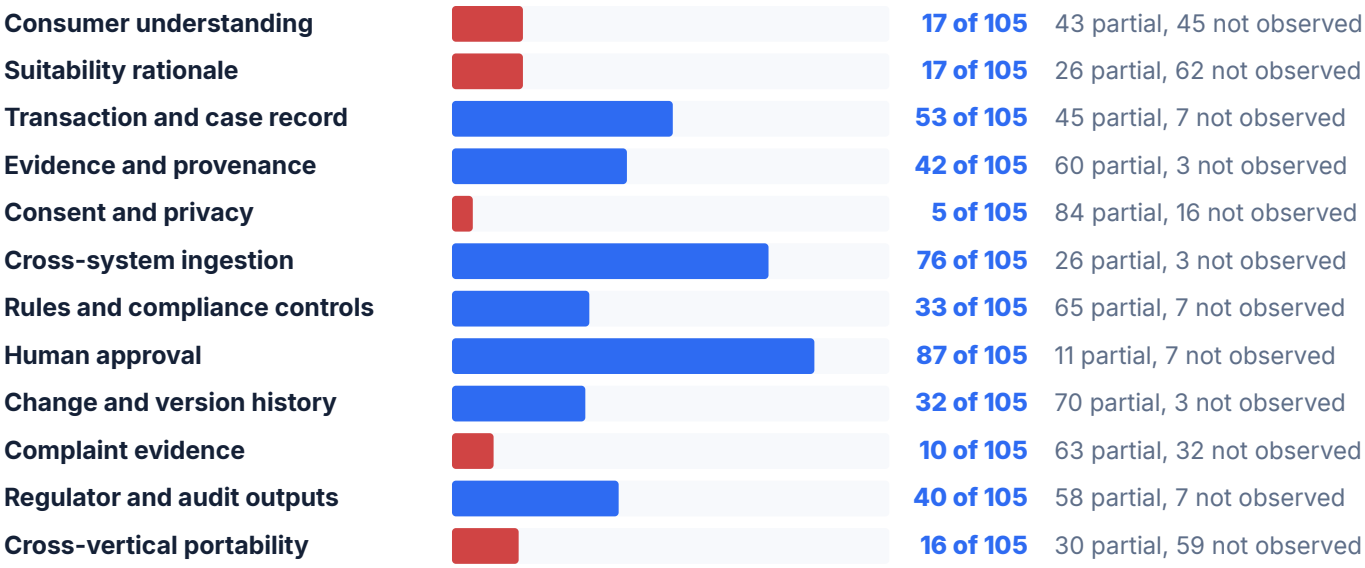
Core means the company markets or structurally owns the capability and it is part of what a buyer is paying for. **Partial** means the capability exists but is secondary, configurable or confined to one workflow. **Not observed** means it was not a central public capability in this scan. That is a research finding, not a claim about what the company could build.

THE REGISTER

Where the register runs thin

The bar is the number of companies out of 105 that hold the capability as a core strength.

EXHIBIT 1 · CORE CAPABILITY BY CATEGORY, OUT OF 105 COMPANIES



Bars start at zero and run to 105, the full register. The note beside each bar gives the partial and not-observed counts, so the three states always sum to 105. Source: public information only, register cut August 2026. Scope: published product pages. Status: our own reading.

Five rows carry the whitespace. Four of them decide whether a file survives being pulled.

Consent and privacy, complaint evidence, cross-vertical portability, consumer understanding and suitability rationale are the categories found least often as a core capability. A vendor that reconciles a ledger and a vendor that records what the consumer understood are not competing today, and a firm buys both and still joins them by hand.

02 · THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

Aveni is the one to measure against, and it is already joining the file.

250+

organisations Aveni says it works with across the United Kingdom

The companies closest to the job we are building are not the governance platforms measured in Part 3. They are the financial-services suitability and customer understanding vendors, and the Canadian mortgage software our first customers already use.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Aveni connects adviser productivity, suitability-file review and customer-outcome monitoring in one place.
- Recordsure and MorganAsh cover suitability evidence and consumer-supplied assessment. Neither is a document tool.
- Filogix, Newton Velocity and Finmo own the Canadian mortgage workflow we have to enter through.

Sources: company product pages and funding announcements, read September 2026. Scope: published material only.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

Aveni is the primary strategic benchmark.

A United Kingdom financial-services AI company, founded 2018, selling adviser productivity, suitability-file review and customer-outcome monitoring on one platform.

Founded	2018. VERIFIED Company boilerplate, funding announcement read September 2026.
2024 funding	**£11M** Series A, announced 29 July 2024. Led by Puma Private Equity, with Lloyds Banking Group and Nationwide as new investors and ParEquity and Scottish Enterprise participating. VERIFIED
2026 funding	**£12M** round, dedicated announcement dated 4 June 2026. Led by PXN Ventures, with Puma Growth Partners, Lloyds Banking Group, Nationwide and Scottish Enterprise named as existing investors. VERIFIED
Scale	Aveni says it works with **over 250 banks, advice networks, wealth managers and compliance providers across the United Kingdom**. COMPANY CLAIM This is a company-reported organisation count, not a verified count of paying contracts.
Annual recurring revenue	Not established in the sources reviewed. Do not infer it from funding or from the organisation count.
Home market	United Kingdom. No Canadian deployment was established in this review.

A note on the funding date.

Aveni's 26 June 2026 article refers to a May raise. Its dedicated funding announcement is dated **4 June 2026**. We use the dated announcement. No verified closing date is claimed, and the inconsistency sits with the two company pages, not with the figure.

Sources: aveni.ai platform page; aveni.ai 4 June 2026 funding announcement; Scottish Enterprise 29 July 2024 release. All read September 2026. Scope: public company material. Status: company-reported unless marked verified.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

What Aveni sells, and what each one overlaps

Five named products on a shared platform. Two of them are labelled beta in Aveni's own site navigation, and that distinction is kept visible here rather than presenting every product as equally mature.

PRODUCT	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS TO US
Assist	Captures meetings, structures client information, drafts documents and supports updates to the system of record.	Overlaps discovery, documentation and professional productivity.
File Check	Compares suitability reports, fact finds and recommendations against the underlying conversation and flags inconsistencies.	Direct overlap with connecting client context to suitability evidence.
Detect	Reviews interactions and complete customer cases for conduct, vulnerability and customer outcomes.	Direct overlap with risk identification, professional oversight and auditable records.
Approve beta	Tests customer-facing AI against policies before deployment.	Relevant to the safeguards around financial AI.
Assure beta	Monitors customer-facing AI interactions in real time and escalates risky behaviour.	Relevant to ongoing supervision of a counselling-centred product.

Approve and Assure are labelled beta in Aveni's current site navigation. Published capability does not establish independent accuracy, availability to every buyer, or suitability for Canadian rules.

Aveni already joins calls, messages and documents at case level.

Its September 2026 case-level outcome testing announcement describes bringing an entire customer case together across channels, covering motor finance, lending and insurance. Any claim that nobody connects the complete file would be inaccurate. What remains thin is the consumer-controlled front end and Canadian rule content.

Source: aveni.ai product pages and the 10 September 2026 case-level outcome testing announcement, read September 2026. Scope: published pages. Status: company-reported capability.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

Financial firms are already buying less administration and stronger client oversight.

Three named United Kingdom deployments, published by the vendor, with starting and ending measurements on the page.

CUSTOMER AND CONTEXT	PUBLISHED RESULT	WHAT IT SUPPORTS
Key Group United Kingdom, later-life lending and advice	Quality-assurance review fell from **90 minutes** to **15 minutes** per case, using Detect. Aveni's own headline is six times the efficiency of a human-only assessment. That is 75 minutes released, or about **83 per cent** less review time, calculated by us from the two reported figures.	Faster review, and more capacity to find the cases that need attention.
Prosser Knowles United Kingdom, financial planning	Post-meeting administration fell from **2 hours** to **45 minutes**, which Aveni describes as about **60 per cent** less administration. Speed to client moved from **4 to 6 weeks** to same day or next day.	Less documentation work, faster follow-up, and a connection into the firm's existing back-office platform.
Octopus Money United Kingdom, financial advice and coaching	**50 per cent** less quality-assurance review time, **50 per cent** less coach case-building time and a **30 per cent** initial adviser post-meeting administration saving, across about **60** advisers and coaches.	Separate benefits for compliance teams, coaches and advisers. These are separate measures and are not additive.

All three are vendor-published customer cases. `CUSTOMER CASE` There is no common experimental design, no comparable cost baseline, and no established 4orm result.

Sources: aveni.ai customer stories for Key Group, Prosser Knowles and Octopus Money, read September 2026.
Scope: vendor-published pages. Status: customer cases, not independent measurement.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

Review coverage, read precisely

Octopus Money's current detailed page reports that the team sampled **15 to 20 per cent** of calls before Detect and now reviews **100 per cent** of interactions. Automated coverage is not the same as a complete human review of every interaction: human reviewers still validate the flagged cases.

Source: aveni.ai Octopus Money customer story, detailed table, accessed September 2026. Scope: one named deployment. Status: vendor-published.

What we should model from Aveni

Packaging and proof

- Sell a specific business outcome: less administration, faster review, clearer evidence.
- Package products around the people using them, so the adviser, the reviewer and the compliance lead each see their own gain.
- Publish named customer cases with a clear starting and ending measurement.

Delivery and trust

- Integrate into the systems the firm already runs, and name the fields and permissions before choosing a connector.
- Keep professional review and accountability visible in the product.
- Show the consumer benefit alongside the business benefit, not instead of it.

Where we have to be additional.

Aveni is a close global comparator combining adviser productivity, suitability-file review and customer-outcome monitoring. Its products connect conversations, documents and professional workflows, which creates substantial overlap with the evidence capabilities we propose. 4orm must demonstrate additional value through private consumer exploration, scenario modelling, selective sharing and delivery inside Canadian financial workflows. `4ORM TARGET` That last sentence is our proposed differentiation, not an established exclusive capability.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

Suitability and consumer understanding

These three sit closest to the job. They belong at the front of any competitive conversation, ahead of the governance platforms in Part 3.

COMPANY	HOME	WHAT IT COVERS	HOW TO TREAT IT
Aveni	United Kingdom	Adviser productivity, suitability-file review against the conversation, and customer-outcome monitoring across a complete case.	The primary benchmark. Model the packaging, the integrations and the published customer results.
Recordsure / TCC	United Kingdom	Suitability reviews, customer outcomes, client meeting capture, populating the system of record, and audit evidence.	Its homepage advertises **50 per cent** cost savings, **90 per cent plus** right-first-time suitability and **35 per cent** more selling time. COMPANY CLAIM Treat these as vendor headline claims until a named implementation and a measurement basis are supplied.
MorganAsh MARS	United Kingdom	Collects assessments directly from the consumer, identifies support needs, monitors changing circumstances, offers support pathways and integrates with existing systems.	This challenges any claim that competitors only look backward or never start with the consumer. Consumer understanding alone is not a defensible claim of uniqueness.

Sources: aveni.ai; recordsure.com; morganash.com customer-vulnerability software page. Recordsure and MorganAsh figures carried from the September 2026 research brief and not re-fetched in this build. Scope: published vendor pages. Status: company claims unless marked otherwise.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

The Canadian mortgage field is the one we have to enter through.

Prioritise the software our first customers already use. These are the systems a broker opens in the morning.

COMPANY	WHAT IT DOES	HOW TO TREAT IT
Filogix	Expert, Expert Plus and FXLink connect Canadian mortgage brokers to lenders. Acquired by Dominion Lending Centres from Finastra Holdings for **C$58.5M** in cash, announced **4 August 2026**, subject to closing adjustments. More than **8,000** brokers connected with about **350** lenders and other industry participants, and about **C$60B** in funded mortgage volume in the twelve months ended 31 May 2026.	Distribution, and a possible partner. Mortgage volume is not software revenue, and an acquisition price is not fundraising.
Newton Velocity	Mortgage application and document intake, brokerage reporting, compliance packages, and anti-money-laundering risk assessment and monitoring.	Belongs beside Filogix. Now under the same parent as Filogix and operating independently, run by Newton Connectivity Systems.
Finmo / Lendesk	Borrower intake, verification and compliance features, including published mortgage suitability form functionality since 2023.	An existing workflow competitor and a possible integration route.
AVA Credit	Mortgage-file tooling with model inventories, usage records, data-handling rules and human review around the file.	Keep its capabilities qualified. They are supported only by the retained internal review, with no paying-customer progress established.
Broki · Blu Mortgage	Broker workflow and client-relationship software, carried in the register as pricing anchors.	Separate businesses and separate price points. Confirm currency, plan coverage and current availability before quoting either.

Sources: Dominion Lending Centres acquisition announcement, 4 August 2026, and contemporaneous trade reporting; newton.ca Velocity and compliance pages; lendesk.com Finmo platform and the 18 April 2023 suitability-forms note. Read September 2026. VERIFIED for the Filogix transaction figures. Scope: public announcements and product pages.

THE CLOSEST COMPARATORS

Other financial and vertical workflows

COMPANY	OVERLAP TYPE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR US
Fenergo	Customer record	Reusable client checks across an institution. The BNP Paribas programme shows one record serving many teams.
Applied Systems	Distribution	Established Canadian insurance brokerage workflow with named Canadian cases. A bundling route, and a bundling threat.
InvestCloud	Future vertical	Wealth-management workflow adjacency. Not a mortgage competitor today.
Blend	Customer record	Digital mortgage intake and consumer preparation in the United States. The closest shape to our consumer front end in another country.
Total Expert	Distribution	Mortgage opportunity identification and follow-up driven from the system of record. United States.
Dealertrack · RouteOne	Future vertical	Automotive retail and finance workflow. Relevant when the automotive skin arrives, not before.
SkySlope	Future vertical	Real-estate transaction records. A price anchor and a later adjacency.

Supporting infrastructure, and the alternatives

COMPANY	WHAT IT IS TO US	WHAT IT MEANS FOR US
Flinks · Plaid	Integration provider	Consumer-permitted account data. Buy, do not build. Flinks already carries named Canadian deployments.
Alloy · Sardine	Substitute for part of the work	Identity, fraud and risk decisioning. They cover part of the intake job and stop short of consumer suitability.
Docusign	Integration provider	Agreement workflow at global scale, with the strongest published time-saving cases in the register.
Pega	Broader platform threat	Decisioning and retention orchestration. Large enough to enter the seam if a customer pays it to.

Sources: company product pages and the vendor-published customer cases carried in the evidence book. Scope: published material. Status: our own categorisation, September 2026.

03 · WHERE THEY STOP

Sixteen rivals, and none holds all eight.

6 of sixteen ship a decision log

Every part of the job ships today inside at least one well funded firm. The case rests on where those firms stop, and on how long they stay stopped.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- None of them is wrong. Nothing here rests on a rival being bad at its job.
- All of them stop somewhere: at a price, at a border, at a scope or at a rule.
- Every stop has a shelf life. Good for about two quarters, then the map is run again.

Sources: each firm's own product pages read 4 August 2026, re-checked September 2026. Scope: published pages. Status: the wall is our own reading.

WHERE THEY STOP

The four walls

Every rival stops at one of four walls before it reaches the Canadian buyer. None of these walls is permanent.

Price	Published pricing sits above what a fifty-person Canadian firm approves without a committee. Pricing is a commercial choice, and a vendor can change it.
Scope	Each one owns part of the job today, not the whole of it. Scope is extended by building or by buying.
Border	Built first for another country's rules. Entering Canada is a roadmap decision, not an impossibility.
Rules	The thinnest wall, and the one most likely to move. Any funded vendor can choose to build Canadian rule content.
Not a rival	More likely to sell for us than against us.

These are findings about present product scope, not permanent barriers.

Pricing, geography and current scope describe where a firm stands today. A funded vendor can change any of them inside a planning cycle, and the rules wall is the one with the shortest shelf life. Re-run this map every two quarters and treat a moved wall as the expected case.

WHERE THEY STOP

Where each rival stops · the border and scope walls

RIVAL	HOME	WHAT IT DOES	WALL	WHERE IT STOPS
Workiva	United States	Joined up reporting, locked record	Border	Large firm reporting, with no Canadian rule content.
Vanta	United States	Continuous control proof, trust pages	Border	Security rules, not consumer transaction rules. Canada would not be its first rule market.
Drata	United States	Control proof with locked change records	Border	Security rules, not consumer transaction rules. The closer of the two to a rule maker.
Alessa, in CaseWare	Canada	Five report types for money movers	Scope	Money laundering work, and nothing in the consumer transaction record.
Unit21	United States	Case work and filing in many countries	Scope	Files Canadian money laundering reports, not the consumer transaction duties.
Case IQ	Canada	Case handling across ten trades	Scope	Case handling, with no rule content and no decision log.
Resolver, in Kroll	Canada	Risk, audit and inquiry work	Scope	Wide risk work, not the consumer transaction and not the file behind it.
SimpleRisk	United States	Open core risk and rule software	Scope	A risk register at a low price, with no Canadian rule content.
Fairly AI	Canada	Model and machine learning oversight	Scope	Built for model oversight, not for the consumer transaction record.

Nine of the sixteen. Product pages read 4 August 2026 and re-checked September 2026. The wall is our own reading of present product scope, not a vendor statement.

WHERE THEY STOP

Where each rival stops · the price wall

RIVAL	HOME	WHAT IT DOES	WALL	WHERE IT STOPS
Nasdaq Verafin	Canada	Financial crime work at 2,800 banks	Price	Priced for institutions. It has not met us in the small firm market.
ServiceNow	United States	Wide risk platform on a work engine	Price	Set up runs up to two and a half times the licence.
Archer	United States	Wide risk platform, long established	Price	Enterprise pricing, well above the level this buyer approves.
MetricStream	United States	Enterprise risk and rule platform	Price	Sold to very large firms, from half a million dollars up.
LogicGate	United States	Configurable risk platform	Price	Mid market pricing, with set up work on top of it.
Optro	United States	Connected risk, controls and testing	Price	Audit and control work at a price this buyer does not carry today.
Diligent	United States	Eight modules, audit and third party risk	Price	Priced above the full duty set, for a different job.

Seven of the sixteen, giving sixteen in all. These counts are the same sixteen used in Exhibits 2 and 3.

Three near neighbours, not rivals

PARTY	HOME	WHAT IT DOES	WHERE IT STOPS
Buying groups and Celero	Canada	Buy software for credit unions	A gate rather than a rival. Treat it as a way in.
Yardi, AppFolio, Buildium	United States	Property software with trust book keeping	Book keeping is not a proof file.
Regulators and rule makers	Canada	Could publish a free template	A template is not a habit, and none has published one.

WHERE THEY STOP

The eight parts of the job

A part counts only where the firm's own published pages say it ships. The same eight are turned on ourselves three pages further on.

01 **Case handling**
One place to run an issue from opening to close.

02 **Proof store**
Where the evidence is kept and pulled back out.

03 **Decision log**
What was decided, by whom, and under which rule.

04 **Approval steps**
Who signs, and in what order, before a thing counts as done.

05 **Change record**
A record of any change, so nothing can be rewritten unseen.

06 **Regulator output**
Sending the finished return or pack to the regulator.

07 **Canadian rules**
Canadian rule content, kept up to date in the product.

08 **Under C$35,000**
A yearly price a fifty person firm approves without a committee. This is a price point to validate, not a contracted price.

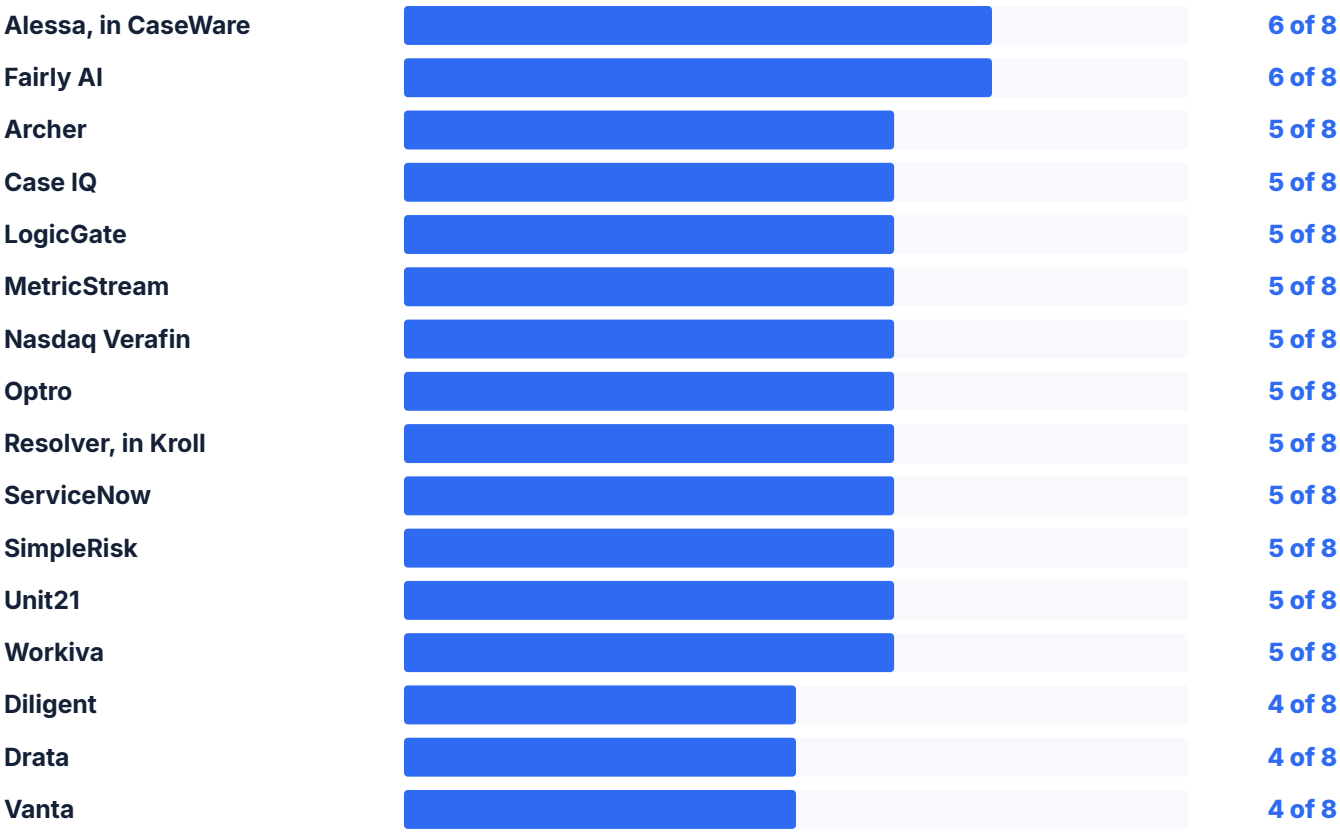
A part counts only where the firm's own published pages say it ships. Our reading of public product pages as at 4 August 2026, re-checked September 2026.

WHERE THEY STOP

How much of the job each rival covers

Sixteen rivals, measured against the eight parts. 4orm is not on this chart: what we ship today is set out on its own page, by delivery status.

EXHIBIT 2 · PARTS OF THE JOB COVERED, BY RIVAL, OUT OF EIGHT

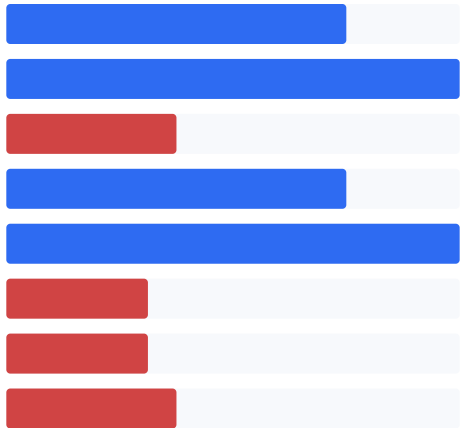


Bars start at zero and run to eight. Sorted by parts covered. Our reading of published product pages as at 4 August 2026, re-checked September 2026. Scope: sixteen named rivals. Status: our own reading, not vendor confirmation.

WHERE THEY STOP

The four thinnest parts, counted

EXHIBIT 3 · HOW MANY OF THE SIXTEEN SHIP EACH PART



Case handling	12 of 16	4 of 16 do not
Proof store	16 of 16	all sixteen ship it
Decision log	6 of 16	10 of 16 do not
Approval steps	12 of 16	4 of 16 do not
Change record	16 of 16	all sixteen ship it
Regulator output	5 of 16	11 of 16 do not
Canadian rules	5 of 16	11 of 16 do not
Under C$35,000	6 of 16	10 of 16 do not

Bars start at zero and run to sixteen, the full measured set. Counts are recalculated from the sixteen named rivals on page 18 and agree with Exhibit 2. Our reading of published product pages as at 4 August 2026, re-checked September 2026.

Holding all four at once is the crossing point.

The decision log, the regulator output, Canadian rule content and a price a fifty person firm approves without a committee are the four thinnest parts. Nothing here says the field is empty. Every part of the job ships today inside at least one well funded firm, and the four thin parts are thin because of commercial choices rather than technical limits.

WHERE THEY STOP

What 4orm ships today, stated by delivery status.

The eight parts again, this time turned on ourselves. No part of this is in production with a paying firm.

EXHIBIT 4 · WHAT 4ORM SHIPS TODAY, BY DELIVERY STATUS

PART OF THE JOB	STATUS	WHAT EXISTS
Case handling	Prototype	A seeded mortgage demonstration runs a transaction end to end. No firm has run a live file through it.
Proof store	Prototype	Evidence capture and retrieval exist in the demonstration build.
Decision log	Planned	Specified in the delivery brief. Not built.
Approval steps	Planned	Specified. The professional review loop is designed, not implemented.
Change record	Prototype	Version history exists in the demonstration build.
Regulator output	Planned	No examiner pack has been produced or reviewed by anybody.
Canadian rules	Planned	Rule content is scoped. None is maintained in a product today.
Under C$35,000	Planned	A proposed price point. No contracted price and no paying firm.

Four statuses are available: planned, prototype, pilot-tested and production. **Nothing in this document is pilot-tested or in production.** `4ORM TARGET`

Why this page exists.

A chart that showed 4orm holding eight of eight beside rivals holding four to six would be comparing a design against shipped products. The eight parts describe the job we intend to do. This table describes how far we have got, and the honest answer is that the work is ahead of us.

Status is management's own assessment as at September 2026 and should be confirmed against the current build before external reuse. Scope: the demonstration build and the delivery brief. Status: 4orm target, not an established result.

04 · WHAT THE MARKET SHAPE SAYS

Three precedents, two of them uncomfortable.

4 proof exchanges built, four swallowed

Two of these three shapes went against the firm that built them.
The third is the one this plan sits in.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Whoever owns the way in owns the market. We do not own a way in and are not trying to build one.
- A middle place nobody has to use does not hold.
- The duty cannot be handed to anybody else. It stays with the firm.

Sources: the bank messaging body's own count of member banks; published records of four proof exchanges and the sales that ended them. The judgement in the third shape is our own.

WHAT THE MARKET SHAPE SAYS

The network owner wins

A bank messaging body runs a know your customer register used by more than **7,000** banks. It won because it controlled the way in, not because its product was better than the alternatives.

The neutral exchange does not

Four independent proof exchanges were built and all four were swallowed by a bigger firm. One gathered **14,000** records against a target of **250,000**. A middle place nobody is obliged to use does not hold.

The firm that owes the duty can be sold to

This is the line the plan turns on. We sell a way of doing a job the firm owns itself and cannot hand to anyone. The duty stays with the firm, and it stays there every day.

SHAPE	WHO HOLDS THE VALUE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR THIS PLAN
The network owner	The body that controls the way in	We do not own a way in. Building one would mean competing with Filogix and Newton for the connection itself, which is not this plan.
The neutral exchange	Whoever buys it	Four were built and four were sold. A middle place nobody is obliged to use did not hold in any of the four.
The firm that owes the duty	The firm, and whoever serves it	The duty cannot be handed on. That is what makes it a repeat purchase rather than a one-time connection fee.

Each shape is the same question drawn three ways.

Who owns the middle, and who ends up holding the value. Two of the three shapes took the value away from the firm that built the thing. The third leaves it with the firm that owes the duty, which is where we sell.

WHAT THE MARKET SHAPE SAYS

What we would grant in a room with any of them

They have more money	Vanta reports **16,000** customers and **US$300M** of annual recurring revenue on its own count, April 2026. `COMPANY CLAIM` Several names here sit inside far larger groups.
They are better built	These are grown up products with years of hardening in them. We would not win a feature comparison on maturity, and we should not try to.
Aveni is ahead of us on proof	It has named customers, published starting and ending measurements and seven years of live deployments. We have a demonstration build and a delivery brief.
What we have is position	A Canadian firm with fifty people, a duty on every consumer transaction, and an examiner who asks for the file afterwards. None of the sixteen is built for that buyer today, and that is a present finding, not a permanent one.

Every stop has a shelf life.

Each wall in this document is good for about two quarters. The rules wall is the one most likely to move, because any funded vendor can choose to build Canadian rule content. Re-run this map on that cycle and treat the walls as findings about today rather than as a defensive position.

Sources: public information only, register cut August 2026. Product pages read 4 August 2026 and re-checked September 2026. Company scale figures are each firm's own published claims.

POSITIONING

What we say, now that the field is named.

The positioning of record.

Established platforms already help financial firms capture conversations, automate administration, review suitability and evidence customer outcomes.

4orm is building counselling-centred AI that helps people privately explore their goals, circumstances, possible outcomes and risks, then choose what to share with the business serving them.

That shared understanding is designed to fit into the firm's existing workflow, reduce repeated discovery and support a clear record of the professional's reasoning.

Our opportunity is to prove that this approach gives firms better client understanding and measurable operating value beyond the tools they already use.

What this changes in the room

Say this

- Name Aveni first, and say what it does well.
- Lead with the Canadian buyer, the Canadian rule content and the mortgage workflow.
- Give the delivery status honestly, then ask for the pilot that would change it.

Not this

- That nobody connects the complete file. Aveni does, at case level.
- That competitors only look backward or never start with the consumer. MorganAsh collects from the consumer directly.
- That a rival cannot reach our price or our buyer. Each of those is a commercial choice a funded vendor can reverse.

Scope: how this document should be used when the company is discussed. Status: management direction, September 2026.

SOURCES

Source register

All links reviewed September 2026 unless otherwise stated. Live pages change: retain dated snapshots before distribution.

SOURCE	DATE AND STATUS	WHAT IT CARRIES
aveni.ai platform	Accessed September 2026	Product suite, beta labels on Approve and Assure, the 250-plus organisation count across the United Kingdom.
aveni.ai funding announcement	Dated 4 June 2026	The £12M round, PXN Ventures as lead, named existing investors, founded 2018.
Scottish Enterprise release	Dated 29 July 2024	The £11M Series A, Puma Private Equity as lead, Lloyds and Nationwide as new investors.
aveni.ai Scotland Fast 50 post	Dated 26 June 2026	Carries a May funding reference that conflicts with the 4 June dated announcement. Noted, not used.
aveni.ai customer stories	Accessed September 2026	Key Group, Prosser Knowles and Octopus Money. Vendor-published cases.
aveni.ai case-level outcome testing	Dated 10 Sept 2026	Calls, emails, messages and documents brought together at case level.
DLC acquisition announcement	Dated 4 Aug 2026	C$58.5M, 8,000-plus brokers, about 350 lenders, about C$60B funded volume to 31 May 2026, Filogix and Velocity under one parent.
newton.ca Velocity and compliance	Carried from the research brief	Application and document intake, brokerage reporting, compliance packages, anti-money-laundering risk assessment.
lendesk.com Finmo; help.finmo.ca	Dated 18 Apr 2023	Mortgage workflow, compliance features and published suitability forms.
recordsure.com	Carried from the research brief	Suitability review, outcomes monitoring and the three headline percentages.
morganash.com	Carried from the research brief	MARS consumer-supplied assessment, support needs, monitoring and integration.
Sixteen rival product pages	Read 4 Aug 2026, re-checked Sept 2026	The eight parts of the job and the wall each rival stops at.

Three pages, marked above, were carried from the September 2026 research brief with their sources named and were not re-fetched in this build. Re-fetch before external distribution.

4orming trust into financial decisions.

People · Trust · Clear Outcomes

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